"I'm single because something is wrong with me."

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Where it often comes from

In a culture and sometimes a church that treats marriage as the normal goal, a single adult can feel like a puzzle others are trying to solve. Well-meaning questions, such as "Why aren't you married yet?" can leave us scanning ourselves for defects. We may blame our personality, looks, past, or faith.

What Scripture teaches

Paul writes, "Each man has his own gift from God; one has this gift, another has that," speaking of marriage and singleness alike. The psalmist says, "I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works." Paul adds that "you have been made complete in Christ." Many people are single for reasons that have nothing to do with a flaw: timing, circumstances, opportunities, or calling. Singleness is not a symptom, and a spouse is not a certificate of normal.

> *"I wish that all men were as I am. But each man has his own gift from God; one has this gift, another has that"* (1 Corinthians 7:7).

Also see

> "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:13–14).

> "And you have been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority" (Colossians 2:10).

> "For there are eunuchs who were born that way; others were made that way by men; and still others live like eunuchs for the sake of the kingdom of heaven. The one who can accept this should accept it" (Matthew 19:12).

> "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope" (Jeremiah 29:11).

Common self-statements

- There must be a reason no one chose me.
- I am too much, or not enough.
- Everyone else sees my flaws.
- If I fix myself, I will find someone.
- Something about me pushes people away.
- I am defective.

Common logical errors

- Personalization: Taking sole blame for circumstances with many causes.
- Labeling: Calling myself defective.
- Mind reading: Assuming others see me as flawed.
- Magical thinking: Believing that fixing myself will guarantee a partner.

Challenging questions

- What reasons for being single are outside my control?

- Do I know happily married people who are no more “fixed” than I am?
- Do I know content, healthy single people?
- What have I been told, and by whom, about being single?
- What does God say about gifts and callings?
- What would living well in this season look like?

Truth summary

> Being single is not a diagnosis. God made me with purpose, and I am complete in Christ. I can grow in healthy ways without believing I am broken, and I can live this season with meaning and joy.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Marriage Guidance
- Gifts, Spiritual
- Will of God
- Thinking, Unhealthy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Truth Be Told — Matthew West featuring Carly Pearce
Honesty about struggles makes room for grace and support instead of pretending to be fine.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God’s loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm single because something is wrong with me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm single because something is wrong with me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What factors affect my relationships?
- ☐ What have I been told?
- ☐ What is true?
- ☐ What does it mean to be complete in Christ?
- ☐ What makes my life full?
- ☐ Who can I serve?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Singleness is not a defect.
- ☐ I am complete in Christ.
- ☐ God has gifts and purposes for me.
- ☐ Many reasons for singleness are not about me.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ I can live well now.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 7:7
  "I wish that all men were as I am. But each man has his own gift from God; one has this gift, another has that."
- ☐ Colossians 2:10
  "And you have been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority."
- ☐ Psalm 139:13–14
  "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Whole and living: Each week, note one thing you did that made your life full, whatever your relationship status.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Colossians 2:10 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am complete in Christ, not defective.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] List the factors. Write the circumstances that have affected your relationships.
- [ ] Answer the voices. Write the comments you have heard and a truthful response.
- [ ] Build a full life. Plan friendships, service, and interests.
- [ ] Memorize Colossians 2:10. Say it when doubt arises.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm single because something is wrong with me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A full life
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm single because something is wrong with me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have asked what is wrong with me. Thank You that I am complete in Christ. Heal the sting of comments, and help me live this season with purpose and joy. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.